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Virginia Board of Education, Lab Schools Standing Committee, Wednesday, February 1, 2023

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UYahbzEwgrM
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-23. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:00:00] we are here for the state board of education's college partnership laboratory schools standing committee glad we don't have to put that on a business card and to discuss the draft process that has been presented to the standing committee for your commission we are going to do a call board and just identify who is here from the same committee both physically present in the room

[00:00:35] to do a foreign check and who may be participating online so do we want to just start here oh absolutely okay son and rotherham and we just can and online pamela pamoran pamoran so as a body of seven uh maybe four of the body president but you can continue with a meeting um and have a presentation and ask questions you just can't make any deliberative decisions is everybody okay with

[00:01:12] that okay all right super um so we have um before us two general documents um to consider the the large document is the draft process um the steward office has um with the help of the superintendent temporarily hired um in a wage capacity a facilitator for the standing committee um while you know we're in a hiring process to replace the board director and um i think that

[00:01:50] that will work for you all which doesn't happen to be available today and so um for the camera i'm melissa schultz i'm the assistant state superintendent i am stepping in not only to provide technical assistance on lab schools but also to guide you through the draft process document that has been created

to help you review form a recommendation and submit a report to the board of education on any submitted lab school outpatients not just the two that are

[00:02:28] currently um uh in interstate that we're in receipt at um some of the information on the at the beginning of this document are being put in here for posterity's sake in the event that anybody else you know cycles in or off so we go through and have the the background in the college laboratory school fund which you all know about and the definitions about lab school if we could move forward on my slide the most significant thing i just want to start with is what the

[00:03:01] general process is it's kind of basic you're in the middle of the sausage making of a lab school application we've got the six steps here just generically without any any detail you receive a lab school application that has been submitted to the department that staff and department and and or i review to ensure that it it's just generally complete you know that it's not missing anything fundamental we're not reviewing it for a recommendation purpose but we're just making

[00:03:40] sure it's complete the standing committee reviews the lab school application you meet by the process document that was previously established by the board with the applicant you allow for a public comment period or hold a public hearing that is not prescribed in detail in the process document you develop and provide a written set of recommendations a written report to the full board that it will be used to consider um for approval and um you provide not only the written copy of

[00:04:17] the report to board but you provide it to the applicant okay if we could go forward the focus of the review process for the standing committee is on the section b part of the um application process document now that that that has a little bit of a misnomer um and i may jump ahead just a little bit um you all will see at um those of you who are on the board will see a presentation tomorrow um where i'm joining the old 2010 slash 2011 process document i'm modernizing it um

[00:04:55] aligning it to the planning grant guidelines and the startup and for people funding guidelines so it is going to look the same when we're finished it's going to feel the same it's going to clear up some things and we're just going to call them the guidelines for um a lab school application process um so the middle section of that that what's a process document right now is you receiving and reviewing meeting with the applicant requesting advisory working for technical assistance from the department conducting the public hearing and developing the recommendation

[00:05:29] report to the board so now i want to go um if you can click to the next page now we are into the elements of the the lab school um recommendation document itself um the first two pages here are what the virginia code says this is what you know why a lab school may be established um on slide seven and then um on the next slide um unfortunately there are 31 statutory essential

[00:06:05] elements that the virginia general assembly previously has built into the code you know whether that will ever be streamlined i don't know but that's what we have to deal with right now and what um how those 31 elements have been translated go to the next slide please as elements in the lab school application process itself they put they're put sort of into buckets into eight buckets that appear within the application that the applicant is asked to respond to um and it's eight plus i call i call it the eight plus one because it's not just being

[00:06:44] that are statutory so those are summarized um executive summary mission and vision educational program the next page governance management structure financial operations placement

plan and other assurances those all 31 that appear in the process document that appear in code fall or folded under one of those eight elements um as part of the application process

[00:07:19] and if you flip over my plus one is the public comment period the public comment period is not required by statute but it is required by the the way the board originally approved the process and that's understandable unnatural that you know the board would want to allow the public to weigh in on any lab school application so let's go to the structure of the report so this is really where since we last met in december this is where the work of the department

[00:07:56] has come alongside to sort of give you some technical guard rails in how the committee may want to and i say i emphasize me because this is still your process but we're trying to um give you the process by which you can go ahead and evaluate if you have the um the document itself if you can turn to page four um it says a structure is provided to assist the standing committee in developing its report to the board and we're like okay how do you as a committee as individual

[00:08:34] committee members look at an application understand that there's some statutory things check marks that you're going to need to meet and then assess because every um applicant is going to be very different in their approach the nature of the lab school you know the students it serves where it serves all of it's going to be very different but you're going to have to answer some basic questions so what we did is we said okay there are there's going to be some focus questions you're going to have an opportunity to look for evidence um as you're going through the focus questions that

[00:09:12] will allow you with this rubric rating that's at the bottom and you so you have three choices on each of these um elements if you are portions of the elements is is it evident that the um i think you can slip forward a couple yeah is it evident that they have produced this information in the application is it emerging or is there partial detail but not all of your questions are answered or do you see that they have fully responded that it's operational or they're ready

[00:09:49] to implement and then there will be a closing overall assessment for each of the areas and then at the end of your process you will be able to do whatever assessment you want of the public comment period um i'm not ready for that yet so i have um i have just as a small exercise

[00:10:18] if people would turn to four which is governance the element of governance so you have an impact statement here that says um and this is just an example of all of these are going to work the same but um the school provides governance and leadership that promotes student performance and school effectiveness that's that's a reasonable standard that you should be able to say can you read the application and determine that they have set up a governance structure that meets the

[00:10:53] standard and then the impact statement goes a little bit further into the questions that are asked for those elements a school is successful in meeting the standard when it's leaders who are who are advocates for the school's vision, who are advocates for the school's vision and improvement efforts.

[00:11:12] What has leaders? The leaders provide direction, allocate resources to implement curricular and co-curricular programs that enable students to achieve expectations for their learning. Leaders encourage collaboration and shared responsibility for school improvement among stakeholders.

[00:11:27] The school's policies, procedures, and organizational conditions ensure equity learning opportunities and support for innovation. Over, then there's a couple of focus questions allow you as you're reading that section of an applicant's information what is the process that they describe for

establishing communicating and implementing the policies and procedures for the effective operation of school what process will the school's leadership use to evaluate school effectiveness and student performance in what ways will stakeholders including staff be given opportunities to provide leadership to provide leadership and to contribute to the decision-making

[00:12:05] process and what policies and processes are in place to ensure equity and learning opportunities so it just breaks it down for you this is these are not check marks that you have to say they do with this but this allows you as you're reading it to think okay am i am i reading what i think i'm reading the real rubric measure comes in when you take that rubric rating of the not evident emerging or partial and operational are ready to implement on the elements that appear in the evidence section and you would apply on the left-hand side in one of those rubric ratings

[00:12:41] and then on the right you would add in comments um and you can do this online you can all do this uh as a you know you can type online this is what the part of the process we'll talk in a little bit about how you figure it out but each of these would get a rating from from each of you on on how you do or you decide as a body together to give it one sub ratings so is the background information on the post founding governing board and if identified the post leaders school and leadership management teacher and then now if you think okay well look they they they described generically but they didn't provide enough detail and you can go through each one of these and then

[00:13:21] you're going to be fulfilling the 31 statutory requirements and then you have an overall assessment if there's an overarching theme or something that you see for one of these buckets one of these eight element buckets and and then as you flip through each of these is the same for those eight elements but you're going to have different metric indicators because each one of these is going to be unique to the statutory requirements you go to all the way to the end

[00:13:54] page 23 24 in this draft document you'll see that there were a couple of concluding questions that the board can use or the standing committee can use to sort of synthesize you know overarching themes or what you feel needs to be expressed that you didn't have the opportunity to express by just giving a loop of reading on one of the indicators um things like you know is there specific feedback that we offer to ensure the applicant can successfully launch what are leisure

[00:14:34] trends or themes um you have the opportunity to do public comment assessment which is outside the statutory guidelines and then what are the proposed lab schools greatest strengths and greatest challenges and that may help the board make some determination about you know does it just need to ask any more questions of the applicant at the board meeting at which they're entertaining it and then finally um there's just some general operating instructions here for you guys um significantly that number one is the organization you all may decide to have a leadership structure

[00:15:10] within the standing committee there's nothing that requires it or prohibits it in the process document it tells you a little bit about each of those components of how you need mercy of applications public comment technical assistance meeting with the applicant development of court and board review obviously the determination of an award of a lab school launch doesn't rest with this body but rests with the body as a whole advance to the draft calendar

[00:15:48] this is um it's not perfect um it's difficult to see is this the same version you said this it is so i reverse engineered this calendar um because it's very important to see how long actually can you we're

going to go backwards to this can we go one slide ahead there should be two yeah this one no the next one so if you start with the end in mind which is when does the board meet you have

[00:16:23] to work backwards and it seems like it's a long time but the department's board agenda item submission deadline is february 28th for example for the march 22nd meeting it seems like oh that's almost a month in advance but it takes the board time to produce the board book have internal meetings determine what other additional information the board may need so there is a very long lead up

[00:16:55] to any board board meeting itself so you cannot say oh well the meetings on march 22nd we'll meet you know 10 days prior and produce the report it just doesn't work that way so can you go backwards one slide so with this in mind um i did a for example so the first one is set wednesday february first the standing committee is meeting um uh jim and the board office can put up public comment

[00:17:29] um on the two for example two applications that have been received if you had any questions now elizabeth yes i just have a legal question can we close public comment on saturday um these public comment forms they're they let us we can do them whenever so that's a fine day okay so i just comment i i will just comment on that the way that i mean i would advise the members of the would be that we count as business days um i know that there's one close on a saturday i saw there

[00:18:05] was one meeting on a holiday you know i think these are minor administrative items that we can tidy up but this calendar can be worked any way you want this is i this i built this this is super helpful i built in formulas but that's why i have the number of calendar days and i have the number of work days um and and that's for the public comment as well as for the committee itself so elizabeth one of the things that i think i'd love to see on this just as you've built you've built out an amazing schedule to kind of forecast like what's the drop-down deadline for an hour to

[00:18:41] go before the board i think we have to have that front deck for us so that documents are coming to us so that we have advanced notice that the public has advanced notice that they could comment on them so that we have the benefit of having public comments um versus the public comment coming after we deliberate so they this column on standing committee you know closed public comment for example i think that your but your deliberation is happening in the 10 plus the the the 18 days - So you have the report period after public comment.

[00:19:19] - But we're not meeting again, is my comment. - That's correct. - So we need to kind of reconjigger, just as you have a process for the board, there has to be a process. I'm gonna say this to the board members or the committee members, right? I think we have to have a process because otherwise it puts too much burden now on staff to interpret public feedback and we don't have an opportunity to act on it.

[00:19:41] So I think this is, it's gonna add a little bit of time, but it's really important to have a good process that everyone can buy into. If you have a good process, we're going to have a better outcome. And right now we just, you know, we're going to need there.

[00:20:00] I think the first time the board, state board, I would feel comfortable giving something to the state board is actually probably now going to be almost like the April meeting because we have to back into opportunity for going with this calendar. You have to have opportunity for, for example, this body to get public feedback, even on the process document that's been placed before us today.

[00:20:25] This is yours. And I'm saying that that's really important to me because this is ours, but how we make this ours and how we make it work for the public is I have to have a comment, an opportunity to comment on this. Because, and the board, the board, gentlemen, you're the board members here.

[00:20:43] I mean, I would, if I was a board member still, I would want this on your agenda. I would want your input on it, because we are here on your bequest. And so if you take this up at your meeting this month, you preview it, you discuss it, how you see this should be run.

[00:21:03] We are merely, as I am just kind of in a lay look at this, you know, I'm merely a judge looking at a rubric that's been set out of the parameters and saying yay or nay or giving some of the technical assistance, but this is ultimately your process.

[00:21:20] JoAnne Hanrahan: So I think companies before the board having them have some input on this, having the public have some input on it, then we can fairly adjudicate based on the parameters but it's not with the absence of public feedback.

[00:21:38] JoAnne Hanrahan: We don't even know what the public thinks about that process, where do we know what the board thinks about the process we're going to find out the board. we're gonna find out with the board we'll discuss this tomorrow i'm i don't know that we need to push to april but i think your point is extremely well taken on making trump process i mean i think we have around the commonwealth we have uh you can kind of pluck it we have some people are very excited about the opportunity to create more options for kids and families and are enthusiastic about this i think you have a bunch of people who are like skeptical if not completely hostile to

[00:22:15] that idea and then you've got a wide spot who just don't know what we're doing what any of this is about i think that that group that doesn't have their mind made up already is the audience we need to make sure has confidence in the process has confidence that there's you know input transparency all that so i am doing i am doing um tomorrow i am doing presentation i love school presentations and board um not for action but just to apprise them this is going to be a part of it um but the delegation that the board has done is allowed us to help facilitate the standing committee so i

[00:22:53] don't i don't know how much the board wants to go back into the cycle after after doing the delegating correct um and so i think it's incumbent upon us which is why we put it on as a as a presentation item for tomorrow just to apprise the board you know this is what the lab scout application process document looks like this is why we're cleaning it up um you know we're going to update what we have on on the map we're going to have an interactive map on the lab schools page to give that status more publicly for async for for everyone i'm going to show in this document

[00:23:28] so i think i think they're in the loop in terms of being apprised um it's just a it's just a question of you know do you do you all want another action item on this i would like one and and i'm also going to say i think it would be very helpful i think one of the documents you had asked for at the last meeting was also i could use the word kind of a flow of what are the deadlines for applicants what might an applicant expect that's part of this right but i think um right

[00:24:02] now just really tactical on this spreadsheet the column i'm hoping to add is the date by which items need to be sent to this committee that those those let's say those materials are sent to this committee x number of days prior to a meeting those materials are made public and there's an agenda i think if we add that kind of column in we now allow for public comments we

[00:24:36] allow these committee members to deliberate so that when we do convene say come march 6th that we have over ducks in a row and i think i was going to mention that just the cadence of the flow of the workload of the number of schools kind of how we see the pipeline coming through the course of these meetings if we're going to be evaluating three two five seven type of things i just i'm still a little not even knowing what the inflow is going to be and then what the management is

[00:25:12] going to be required of us and just um and i i agree with you on the time for the public comment that i just kind of that point too i really you know with the presentation tomorrow what's going to be on the docket for the board of the march meeting the gay pro meeting um the substantive standpoint right so um so this is my my you can always give away land you own philosophy i must credit my husband very famous american um you don't have to have all these meetings

[00:25:50] but by placing them on the calendar and placing a hold what that says is should a lab school application come in there it's a rolling application process there are no dates because an ihe and its partners and its school division if it's partnering with the local school division they will you know reach the day come off of their of their application process when they do um we you know um so by having this as a known schedule they could adjust their cadence to say

[00:26:28] hey if i want my my lab school application considered for the april meeting it's probably a pretty good idea that i understand when this board may when this body may meet um and we can certainly um we we could even as soon as we get the application we could add into the process once we turn it over to you we just start the public comment period then we just initiate the public comment period i think for this first one we're off cadence because it's the first one you

[00:27:03] know you're just now you know getting up and running um so i would strongly recommend that even if it's a little bit uncomfortable that you drive those first two applications for the march meeting because they've been in for a while and yes it took us up and running but they're ready to go and they're ready to be evaluated and if they've gotten feedback we can parking like that but i also prize them of this schedule that's been given to you all as a draft and i've said everything was dependent upon the body itself but that this is what i would anticipate so they are

[00:27:43] aware um joan to your to your question i think the board bylaws still require seven days for preparation and provision of materials to the board would you all be comfortable with that or would you like a longer number that's consistent with the board and i think that's yeah thank you that's exactly and so if we just kind of the the box of the board deadlines for materials yeah we just put that on the front end of the desk and it's a mirror image yeah so the same thing the board does the standing committee does on behalf of the board right so when when we set these dates then we'll just have the you know seven days before and we'll try to make sure you

[00:28:22] on next room again yeah every business day we'll do our best yeah i think that i i hear your point of that should just be in compliance i think it's i think it's i prefer business days but if the board does calendar days we should do calendar days just so people aren't confused about these processes um your presentation tomorrow is going to reference the two that are already pipeline and prepare the board for the march meeting so okay jim works every day by the way

[00:29:01] what's a not a business day also with one of these dates being on labor day and two that i know that i'm out of town for does it matter i just opened up between the seven of us and again this is a plug and play you'll see on the calendar that i distributed to you in the lower left it's got in the holidays so that's why

the period of work days is you know changes any one of these can change i think yeah i think it would be helpful just to quickly make sure we're going to be able to have quorums and and make sure the board members of this committee

[00:29:40] committee members appreciate the expectation and then um uh also to figure out locations collectible plan i i felt like that george just given the geography of a lot of folks that george mason location was excellent if we could just have that space on a regular basis with good facilities easy for people they want to come and participate and and megan i don't know if you have access to that information from the original orientation um maddie yeah okay and it seems like just given the composition of the committee where people either live or are for work frequently or whatever that

[00:30:14] we will be able to uh and i've gotten a read um and it may not be perfect um but if lorraine is facilitating your meetings she actually doesn't have to be physically present with you she could attend by zoom if you all are all physically present um sure if we can also i mean madison has a lot on her plate and so she wouldn't yeah yeah i can do that separate as long as we have four board members and i think that location gives us our best yeah we've done the handoff from the secretary's office to the department because the board office should really be be doing that so

[00:30:49] that's why we we got lorraine from you all and and she has a background in and she's actually an attorney um she has a uh venez vineski um you should have gotten um i think at least one email from her um and uh she has a background in facilitating um i do just want to point out for the record even though we're not taking any votes or anything jones heroic efforts to get to richmond you hear in person i do yes i i do like she and her husband like heroes uh to be here it's

[00:31:21] pretty it is extremely appreciated extremely appreciative um of her husband who was who was yes pam oh sorry i'm maddie i'm so sorry to interrupt john bailey is trying to get on the team's meeting which is what was sent around on the calendar invite so megan i don't know if you want to call him oh never mind he's just going to zoom disregard he's figured it out okay that's perfect all right pam do you have any comments to weigh in there are a couple things

[00:32:00] that i just wanted to weigh in on is that i i do think that public tends to think about public comment through a business day model versus just a a straight run of the calendar model so just to think about that um that may be um something just to think about in terms of how we set that public comment calendar but the other piece that i i really want to uh comment on about getting the meetings set and publicized is that for school divisions obviously they are trying to hit the

[00:32:38] mark in terms of their gates for knowing that a program like this is going to get approved and be able to be in that startup mode to be ready to go at the point where they're planning to uh do an opening whether it's at the beginning of the year and in some cases people may decide to open um later in the year than that it could be a mid-year opening but really just trying to make sure that what we're building gives schools adequate time if they're thinking that they're going to open i think that that a june 5th or a july 31 um meeting that we just need to caution

[00:33:15] folks that um if it gets approved on that date that they've got to be really ready to make their start um and to make sure that we know that where they are in that process hi john right so we that's really why i think it's important that you all decide um which you can't decide but you can decide at your next meeting but you can give guidance to us in helping build your calendar you can set your calendar regardless and and make an official vote um at subsequent meeting but if

[00:33:53] you would like to post this as a as a draft calendar and you could give us guidance oh we really want that that second column that says public comment work days we want that to be you know seven um seven work days we want that to be ten we want it to be two weeks whatever it is that you want um it gets published at town hall and it will be put as a notice on the board section of the of the website so those will both be out and it's just how much time we can we can buy back time

[00:34:29] that will not change your meeting dates by just saying as soon as you know if you want us to as soon as we turn over a lab school application to you all you know i don't know the time between when that happens and when you'll next meet but you could open we could open a public comment period right away i just suggest that you have a standard comment period um that you that it might be three weeks for one and a month for another one and 10 days for another one that it just be you just sort of adopt just like you were saying for hey seven calendar days we know that we're

[00:35:05] going to get before meeting you know we'll have the agenda and we'll have any applications to consider um at that time and then whoever whichever um ihe um so for the the sake of your sanity and efficiency okay and pam i really appreciate your your remark also on the the september date and the october date of almost just having what i heard through your comment was even maybe having a meeting in september october could almost be confusing to a potential applicant because they

[00:35:40] can't open school per se for the fall of 2023 so might we have almost a no meeting september october and then kind of open for business again say november of 2023 which would be for applications for the you know the fall of 2024 kind of thing so just kind of something to i think all of us to think about and pam it's a really great insight the flow if i'm an applicant what you're also really saying is if i'm an applicant and i put my document in what's the date by which and this is really a gem for you know what's the date by which i must file that with the standing committee

[00:36:20] so that there can be action taken and what's the expectation for a timeline for review which is really also getting to the bills question a couple of things there one you could have a school that is ready to open mid-year i mean they they could get they could get wind of this and they could have a turnkey facility ready and they said look you know we're ready to start with a pilot of you know say we're going to do um six seven and eight okay and um you know we have a a group of sixth graders that we've identified um we're ready to start them in the spring um or it could be

[00:36:56] we have a heavy lift we have a big endeavor that we're planning for the success of fall and we need as much runway as possible i wouldn't short i wouldn't short anyone the opportunity on a rolling basis i would just say that i think just august is always a death month no matter what so maybe just maybe just killing the september meeting and having a november meeting so i um i have a i didn't actually have you meeting in august i know that and i'm saying july 31 to september 4th that every day window is going to be that time at most places so yeah if we killed the september meeting and included a november meeting i think it would kind of

[00:37:35] well i don't i don't board meetings okay so do you just take this back do you all have a november board meeting i don't we do it's uh second i have to check with second and third four obviously the 15th and 16th okay oh yes so those yeah we haven't clicked forward can we can we click forward to the next calendar because i think this calendar is built out yes right so it is the october meeting is built up to the november but we could plan the november one in anticipation

[00:38:12] of your january okay so so what i was going to try to i'm going to volunteer myself to work with elizabeth yourself and jim and rogan to gather input from committee members and then work with you to fine tune this excellent draft working calendar it's the first time i've seen kind of some it's great i'm so happy to see this because you're really kind of laying out hey here's the

[00:38:45] process here's the timeline here's what it's gonna look like um but why don't we john if you have any specific thoughts on this that you'd like to verbally share or if not you know since everyone is kind of maybe get a chance to look at this really think about it and i don't know megan if there's a way for all of us to group comments together um and and then you know i can see that so if you know andy or bill or john have additional thoughts you can send it in an email to me or to

[00:39:22] everyone to see probably that's the best and then i can work with the staff team to give you kind of 2.0 on this if that's comfortable and then we can move on to the next item on the agenda can i ask you a question is that are they are they um on the contemporaneous meaning if there's a shared document are they allowed to put comments into a shared document as long as they don't do it contemporaneously never thought about that before normally normally staff would collect comments individually from each member and then do a compilation um which is preferable i think so

[00:39:57] yeah so so what you could what do you can each do is um you have the standard process document in draft you could literally just load you know and attract changes you could load your comments and send the document to joan and then joan the staff will help you you know i'll help them i'm guessing the rain will be yeah yeah lorraine is going to facilitate changes you know so if everybody just wants to comment on the word document and send those in and on the calendar

[00:40:32] as well you know but i i've heard um that really this september is not any meeting in september is not optimal um but that we could add a november meeting in anticipation of january and um and then also build in the seven days and maybe reverse engineer a little bit of the comment period and and that drop dead deadline you know the mirror image of the process for the board let's

[00:41:01] Karen Grove: let's have that front end process for the standing committee so there's kind of a that find an example of a I dropped a deadline by which an applicant needs to submit materials if they want consideration. Karen Grove: And then I think that starts to help everyone anticipate it's the worst it's less about the due date and more of a target date for potential for them to see them out exactly okay.

[00:41:34] Okay, if we can go forward, I had built in a break. I don't know if we really need one. And I want to just for the end of it. And then also, when we get these documents and these materials that we're seeing today up on the board's website or up on the standing committee's website, we can also take comment on these items.

[00:41:54] If the public has any thoughts on a calendar, any of the things that we've just discussed, we can take that comment and take that into consideration and modify as appropriate. there a um standing committee holding spot on the board's website we do have the standing committee's page that we can put documents up on yeah yeah all right all right um we're not going to adopt anything but we've got the process moving along we're going to pass by the break okay a few

[00:42:28] reminders just top level things um as we discuss standing committee meetings are public meetings because you can't determine today but it sounds like the suggestion is put some holds on the george mason university site that seems to be our best bet for quorum and i don't know if any of the dates

you'll want to do this again which is meet before the board meets not if we're doing it up there obviously that i think that doing it up there or in advance on that cadence we discussed gives us the ability to have a meeting that's going to be quorum have time in between so that

[00:43:08] the board can get necessary materials so i think we want to make sure but if it can't be it cannot be right before the meeting because that'll the people we have we have an executive session this morning in an hour or two and so half an hour thank you john and pam does the george mason university slot work for you all is it equidistant yeah it is eddie just for my own clarification purposes is participating through zoom or teams does that count towards quorum or do you need to

[00:43:43] be physically in okay you missed a four-hour conversation about that this morning no i'm sorry i had two different two different links today is a committee of the of the board and you all have the same obligations which is you you need to have a quorum physically present in the room but then beyond quorum people can participate got it okay so as long as you meet the um the tick mark of the quorum then everybody else can participate virtually okay i see okay um covered

[00:44:22] foia meeting dates will be done um coordinate what happens outside of um meeting dates um this is the you know if it works the cadence that you find um that you're looking for of maybe making comments directly onto a word document and sending them into lorraine i think that's going to take one or two iterations for you to figure out and that will continue to be refined because it's not only what you discuss at the meeting it's what happens outside the meeting

[00:44:57] that's really that that's where a lot of your work is going to be done and it has to work for you all as very busy people okay next one preview coming changes um the lab the unwieldy named lab school application process document which will you know be newly christened you know the lab school um application guidelines um will be cleaned up and be presented you'll see those i jenna i can send

[00:45:30] you um and pam and john um the board members got it as a part of their board book but i will make sure that you all get a copy of the red line changes that are anticipated um it looks like it's a lot it isn't really um they're cleaning up things like at some point it makes it sound like the applicant is different than the eligible entity um they're just a bunch of cleanup that needs to happen like when the public comment happens is in the wrong place and i think it'll just be streamlined if i had to write and create the document all over again i would make a

[00:46:07] completely different document but i don't want to you know i don't want to push the committee or the board too hard right now so we're just going to make it better um and then as soon as i get a nod tomorrow from the full board that the process document yes please do clean that up then we will do the commensurate um changes to the last classification itself it will help us um far better you know we've gone through this process as a department of needing to like synthesize large amounts of data but where's the lab school going to be what's the name of the lab school who

[00:46:47] are the partners who are the divisions how many students do they anticipate when do they anticipate like all of those are like data points that aren't really represented very well in the application process hard for us to like you know suss out and so we're trying to you know everything we're doing is trying to make this process a little bit better okay next steps um have you all thought about or discussed at all like having a chairman or vice chairman or brandy coobah yeah i mean obviously

[00:47:23] again this is uh yeah this is a discussion meeting it's not a quorum so i'm not making a motion or sing or um i'll make sure that's clear for anybody watching this now or later but i do think something we should consider joan wadiska brings a lot of experience to the board around this uh work both this would be just as you heard this morning and unless being just on sort of good process and how to do this in a way that you know has integrity and public confidence also you know domain expertise uh i think would be would be fantastic to uh chair this committee going forward and if we i will say if we had a quorum that is a motion i would have uh wanted to offer for this uh this committee i

[00:48:02] don't know about their second vote if we were seconding yeah no but i'm sorry i think thank the good thing is we have a whole time so we can we can discuss it and so forth but i wanted to you know put my cards on the table about the direction i think uh we should go and why well and that helps formulate the success of agenda that you will next time have seven days before you is you know i would uh i hire me i would would definitely uh support that motion

[00:48:37] at the next week does have all of the qualifications that you uh just laid out and uh if she was willing to consider it i think we'd all be thrilled if we had quorum i think it would be unanimous if we had quorum so yeah is there a possibility well i think um we've already committees kind of already decided that joan's going to be facilitating a couple things she's volunteered at this yeah yeah so i think i think it's a natural thing at the next meeting yeah so it'll be formalized yeah we can do that at a meeting

[00:49:16] where a requirement yeah all of that so we will add a consent agenda item to your next we haven't given jones to make her sherman as a statement yeah i am i am happy to be of assistance if anyone else wants to serve in that capacity by all means i'm happy to not do it equally as well but i i'm happy to assist everyone and want to make sure that we have

[00:49:52] the help provide support for the board and we've got a clean process well the committee might also want to consider a second um offering sacrificial offering uh you know to help jones just in the event that you can make a meeting we have someone else to facilitate so um you know if there is another volunteer out there that would be great because i think if i kind of put on my former state board hat i think you know it really works well we work as a team because we have someone else to bounce ideas off of to help facilitate hey what should be on the agenda what's coming up if you know and would you want the you know if there was just as you know was indicated in the primary

[00:50:32] if there was feedback that might be wanted to be provided to an applicant who would be the perfect person to do that do we want staff to do that or do we want a member of the board or someone in leadership so what these are kind of things that we'll sort out as we're all figuring this out but um if anyone would like to co-ride with me i would be delighted to have your assistance i see crickets i think this i think this conversation are on new york yeah i'm gonna i'll chat with everybody after this discussion right there sorry now who may have the time to do this um which i

[00:51:09] know is sometimes for the board members who serve this is already triple and sometimes quadruple right and and and the hope is that that the chair will have a very good working relationship with lorraine and lorraine can help you know you all can develop your own internal cadence you know if you will um but let's just talk um for a moment because the committee you know got off um to a start with its orientation and meeting with the ihe's um jmu james madison university and southside

[00:51:49] uh virginia community college um i i i do think because of the time lag between when they applied and when we got to where we are now that um you know my my strong suggestion is that you find

a way to do this evaluation for the market mostly because they're ready to go this fall and the more runway we give potential applicants particularly with the existing barriers which we're going to

[00:52:25] reduce amongst the barriers that um and things that i'm putting up in the process document you know an artificial deadline that you had to apply a year in advance nobody knows where that came from or why it's there you know nine months in advance this and six months in advance that um the you know we can't go back and kind of figure out why those those were there and um you know we can make a good case for why they should be there so we are going to reduce those but there has been a request that you know if you know whatever leave time you can give them they could

[00:52:57] use um so the the ability exists for us to immediately put up um public comment and keep it open as long as you want um but finding that internal process for you all to follow um i think it was part of a discussion we'd have in this most immediate next step but with the peer that we should at least put their two applications up on say the committee's website ask for public comments have the benefit of getting that information and then we can uh at the march

[00:53:35] meeting we're kind of following order you know be able to deliberate on that item i do i would appreciate it if staff could advise us on a mechanism for each of the members here to give input on these applications and i think there's i think everyone had a couple more questions for each of these applicants that we haven't had an opportunity to have answered yet

[00:54:09] and certainly i think we should also have a conversation briefly about the role of the committee i know we have kind of to act as review these items and see if it fits within the rubric and then advise the state board we don't make a yes or no we very advise i do think there are instances for applicants where a refinement an improvement or an amendment to their application may enhance our advice and counsel those so you know i think we just all need to think about that

[00:54:45] a little bit but at the very next step it is let's get these applications up on our website let's ask for public comments and then we can take that in and then start moving through this document too which is your process and rubric so in setting expectations um you know i try to anticipate um questions and next steps so you know i'm looking a little bit over the horizon and i i have advised the two ihe's exactly that that that be that the reason i gave them the schedule that was given to you is here's the window in which it is highly likely and reasonable

[00:55:24] to expect incoming questions from this committee and the incoming questions could be anything you want which is you know in the governance or the target student population or whatever you know please submit a letter you know an amendment you know identifying these topics you can ask them whatever you want and so if you have a suite of questions they're primed as i would say this would be the similar process to anything which would follow which is you get something in you got a series of questions you collect you know the respective numbers um uh

[00:56:03] questions eliminating duplicates you know use lorraine and board office and off off uh an inquiry goes and and that's they're in the in the cycle for receiving and responding um to questions and preparation of the march board meeting so yep bravo yes so on that do committee members have a

[00:56:37] thought opinion on if questions are gathered from from all members staff will gather those they'll go back to the university of the applicants the applicant can answer back in writing or do you want it to be a conversation or some hybrid of the two and and and here's the reason i'm asking is i can do you

want me to kind of get some context on this well no no no please keep going i was just thinking like kind of doing this and making sure we have public yeah yeah the public means public visibility is a little complicated yeah so there's there's times i'm thinking about

[00:57:17] when we would go through school accreditation here's the example in my head that sometimes you want to just be able to you know you can have it in a public conversation or you can have a meeting where you sit down let's say with the applicant and say hey here's some questions i have about your application here's some like minor changes that you might be advised to make or you know it's your choice but let's just have that conversation um where it's being done as a collaborative it's being done as a partner right um so sometimes it's how many sometimes it can be really burdensome for let's say we ask one of the applicants questions and they have to respond back in writing

[00:57:56] that can be an administrative burden in and of itself to respond in writing or sometimes in the translation of back and forth and documentation something really gets lost about say what was really the intent of my question i think in an ideal circumstance we would have an applicant apply we would get public comment on that application the applicant would come before this body we would ask them questions have that deliberation real time and be done and if there

[00:58:29] were refinements necessary their applicant would refine resubmit an amendment and that process would go as far along as the applicant or the committee needed ideally be very short you know i anticipate that in six months that's exactly how it's going to work right and okay and i think and i think what you're right now doing is you're noodling through how you you know that first rocket launch correct and everybody's a little bit nervous because they haven't seen the rocket launch

[00:59:03] before so such a great example considering the rocket lab yay virginia's lover loves launches so yes i anticipate that by the time you meet in ihe you will have had a little bit more you're a little more long in the tooth with with this process but because as a public body open meetings law is two or more there's nothing that prohibits um one of you from having a

[00:59:38] conversation with an ihe with lorraine to document you know questions so incoming questions could be correlated the board office can provide support and i don't know somebody um could pick up the phone and have a zoom call with them um asking clarity on on particular things and noting it for for the board 20 sorry how do others feel about what elizabeth just stated is that give anyone is that comfortable for everybody yeah one thing that i want to be sure that we

[01:00:13] take into account is that um process is so critical in this because if we are having questions i i know that it was just brought up i think joe you brought up the idea that there could be some refinement or even some slight revision of an application i think that needs to be part of the process that would be very explicit as to when that would happen would it be before or after a meeting if revisions were going to be made how would that become part of sort of the public um

[01:00:51] understanding of what might be changing about an application how would i think that this is a really critical conversation because um there should be one person probably designated to speak with an applicant on behalf of this group so that all of the questions are are being known to the whole group that are moving to the applicant i don't know if i'm making sense from this virtually but just trying to be sure that we get that lined up very clearly for an applicant to know are they going to be expected to potentially have to do some revisions before a final decision

[01:01:28] or would we have that meeting and then give them direction to make a shift before we would take that application forward based on our consensus that there needed to be some change and that's incredibly clear here i just want to restate so you're really advising on also we have to ensure there's a fair process for the applicants that the rules are the same regardless of where you are in the process regardless of where you apply so um i can give you an example because you know because i run the funding evaluation review committee which is the the department's um

[01:02:06] committee that uh reviews and awards the planning grants so we're reviewing them and going through the planning grants we have three internal reviewers and three external reviewers i rotate um i don't we decided as a body that we would rotate in three member panels um so all six of us don't review every planning grant but we're on a rotation and we we we allow like look if there's a something that comes up in that review we don't want to i mean the whole goal

[01:02:41] is for people to be successful at this you know i mean we want ihe's we want eligible entities to be successful we want lab schools to serve not only students and academic excellence and an opportunity pathways for students but also for the incubation for the development of teacher pipelines you know there's a there's good that comes out of this so if an organization a higher ed center or a community college or um or a four-year university if they have something that they can do it to make it better we want to facilitate that we're not going to be a high bar

[01:03:21] barrier um of entry into becoming um a planning grant awardee or allowed school awardee so um as long as is your public that you know look there were things in this application that um you know we had questions about we solicited a response from the applicant and uh hear their responses and then you have your report i think that speaks for itself um i i appreciate very much the fact that we want to be public about this and and we do um but what we don't want to do is have

[01:03:54] an artificial i think set of of structures that say well you didn't apply by the state so you know we're not going to entertain you or we have this question and um you know it wasn't included in the application so you got to start you know go back to you know go back to square one start over so let me suggest this in the interest of time i think if we had kind of a let's have a let's have staff work on putting together a flow document on the consideration of applications so we've got

[01:04:26] this rubric which is what we would apply to applicants but what we need is a flow document of an entry point into this process that's a bit more detailed because you've you've appropriately acknowledged that has to be determined by the committee so let's have staff put together a strong document on a flow document that takes into consideration what pam's noted that it is a public process that you know we are advising we i think ultimately what's going to happen is we're going to hang our hats on this rubric we're going to look at this room we're

[01:05:03] going to have so the applicant's going to submit an application this is how i think it might work They submit an application. That application goes up for public comments. The public comments, we see that public comment in advance of the meeting. The applicant comes to the meeting.

[01:05:22] We can ask questions of the applicant at that time. Then this committee would deliberate with the scoring rubric. We would determine their score or if additional information is needed. that would be noted and then at that point it is of the applicant's choice and this is my view they can take counsel from this committee or they don't have to and when we are in an advisory because our score would be our score

and if they want to refine their application to some of the feedback that's been provided they may choose to do so or they may choose that you know what really

[01:06:00] happy with our application we're comfortable with it going forward to the board it is as is and then we can file our report to the board and they will ultimately act but we're kind of filtering through but do you want do you want in that flow flow do you want the ability to consider so um you know every question that you have is not going to come to mind or be answered in the meeting where you meet the ihe and you get to ask questions things will come up later do you do you

[01:06:38] want a uh if you will on your flow chart a dotted line that you know if there's questions we go to the ihe the ig has the opportunity to respond and submit back and then and then you complete your and i think that would be my intent and i would want to hear what other committee members have to say about that but it would be my intent but there's always a balance here of i would my intention of that would be to have a partnership and a collaboration and see this committee as providing technical assistance because when you think about who's on this committee some powerhouse expertise that an applicant really might benefit from the balance there however is i also don't

[01:07:18] want them to get stuck in a rube goldberg process where they can't get out of it they're happy with their application they don't want to make changes and they just want to go before the board for consideration so i think it is it is a mutual process of the committee can have an iterative questions and the applicant um can also say hey i'm just comfortable as it is i don't want to make changes and i think that that lends itself to i think for all of us who've been through a grant review process there comes a point just put me before the body i'm ready to go i want to get this

[01:07:52] this cracked out so i think we need to have that and but the intent here is to to provide technical assistance support to further enhance um but it is of the choice of the applicant and then you know in a reasonable time frame maybe it's a one review so typically the state board before you know items would come before the committee the board maybe once maybe twice and then final action so that's something for again everybody to kind of think about do you need to see something once would you like to see it previewed once have discussion with the body do this iterative

[01:08:27] process and then at the next meeting i'm happy to do a you know a straw man flow chart um for you to try to to capture this i don't think that's that that's easy i may even be able to have this out to you guys you know in short order and then everyone can look at it the public can look at it and then if everybody's going on the process we can start to move forward with you know again your draft document here also being the undergird we're going to use the rubric right we don't get of opinion on how to grade or score that's been set up by the general assembly of the board on our

[01:09:02] we just have to apply this these rubrics and parameters all right any other questions answers i want to be mindful of your time q a you're on mute yeah you're on mute sorry i need my coffee mug up here the um one question i had is do you see the rubric as more formative feedback to the uh um entity prior to us meeting in that final sort of decision-making mode so that they

[01:09:38] can use that information is that the process no i i really imagine that the rubric is the mechanism by which this as a deliberative body um informs the their recommendation report to the board you're just measuring what's what's already in the application what we're contemplating is just adding a step that allows that cycle which i've already pre um you know pre-configured with the

[01:10:14] two applicants so expect in the next couple of weeks that there could be answers from this committee um and and kindly be poised to be responsive and what we're just trying to do is more formalize that process on a going forward basis for subsequent applicants so the first time we meet with them and we have an opportunity to ask questions is more of them getting formative feedback the rubric really is a summative assessment of their proposal yes ma'am

[01:10:49] okay so um we have a draft um we'll work with megan and and crew to look at the at the george mason facility and propose that for your future consideration um for the next dates and um yes i think the other kind of a homework for each of us respectively it will be to look through this working draft calendar and look through this glow document and then immediately the questions these focus questions and the rubric since that will be the

[01:11:29] document that really guides a yay may advisory it's to spend a little time with that and submit our collective thoughts to staff to be clear the river of the framework was based off of previous this was completely written to help you now this is to help for you all to say how do we how do we evaluate because if you recall i wrote a rubric for the planning grant guidelines

[01:12:00] it's super clear um it's just because of the statutory 31 elements it's so you know it's it's unwieldy and so it's okay how do i help you figure out how to look for 31 elements and i just tried to make it as plug and play as possible when you're looking for 31 things that are in eight buckets very sorry but i have to put these two yes yes okay well we don't even have to officially adjourn officially call the order but it is what it is thank you um john and cam i hope

[01:12:39] to get to see you at a successive meeting i appreciate your being available virtually to participate provide feedback and look for more information to come president